

Digital Drawing Pad

I am a regular reader of EFY, interested in assembling the 'Digital Drawing Pad Using Graphical LCD and Touch Screen' construction project published in EFY Sept. 2012 issue. Where can I get the touch screen (resistive type) and graphical LCD?

Himanshu Singh
Through e-mail

The author Vineet Nayak replies:

Touch screen can be purchased from any mobile spare shop or online store from the link 'http://www.onlinetps.com/shop/index.php?main_page=product_info&cPath=17_87&products_id=1141'. Graphical LCD (KS0108, 128x64 type) can be purchased from any of the online stores at the link 'http://www.onlinetps.com/shop/index.php?main_page=product_info&cPath=9_41&products_id=175'

Door-Opening Alarm

I am interested in assembling the 'Door-Opening Alarm' circuit published in Dec. 2011 issue. Please tell me how to do the setup after assembling the circuit on the PCB.

Mohan Kumar
Through e-mail

The author T.K. Hareendran replies:

As clearly mentioned in the article,

'Spot An Error' Award Winners

In the 'Standalone GPS Receiver with LCD Display' construction project published in EFY January issue, X1 connector shown in Fig. 5 is for 9V AC input from the transformer's secondary terminal.

Adil Khan

❑ In Fig. 3 of the 'Remote Control Using Wireless Doorbell' circuit, the value of R5 should be 4.7 kilohms.

Adil Khan

❑ In the 'Cellphone-Based Remote Controller For Water Pump' circuit, MT8870 is misprinted as MT887 in the sentence "Use suitable IC socket for MT887 and NE555 ICs" on page No. 121.

Somnath Biswas

From Facebook: EFY's Electronics Design Community

The 'How to Select A Microcontroller' article published in Dec. 2012 issue is very good for beginners as well as those who are new to microcontrollers.

Pranjot Talkar

❑ Thanks to EFY for considering my problems and dispatching a new certificate and CD of EFY Electronics Rocks 2012. Best wishes!

Ropesh Thouna

❑ I need a circuit for controlling home appliances like fans, lights, etc via relays using presence-sensing PIR modules. Please help.

Abinand Grandeur

PIR module is for one appliance only. All PIR sensors have sensitivity and hold time control knobs. For example, hold time of up to one minute means the appliance will be 'on' for that time and then switch off automatically and wait for the motion to get detected. If you still want to extend the 'on' time of the appliance, you just use a 555 circuit. So the PIR module is basically easy to interface to a relay with transistor and diode.

Rajesh Varma

assemble the circuit on a general-purpose PCB and enclose in a suitable cabinet. Connect the piezobuzzer at the back side of the cabinet. Next, install the unit on the swimming pool door as shown in Fig. 2 of the article. You can use short-length, flexible wires to connect the reed switch to the circuit. The reed switch and magnet assembly can be fitted in appropriate positions using any strong glue or double-sided tape.

Remote Phone-Bell Ringer

In the 'Remote Phone-bell' circuit published in Nov. 2011 issue, what is the need of a separate battery?

Anirvan
Kolkata

Colin Mitchell from electronicsforu.com replies:

The circuit can be made much simpler. Since the piezo sound is required for such a short time every day, the circuit can use four AA-size cells. The two 47-kilo-ohm resistors can be replaced with a single 100-kilo-ohm resistor, while the lower 100nF capacitor can be removed. Do not earth the project. Remove the transformer and bridge. Connect the collector of T1 to the collector of T2 and remove the 100-ohm resistor. Remove D6 and R5 as well. Now you have the same circuit with half the parts.

The author Raj K. Gorkhali replies:

A separate 6V battery must be con-

nected to power the buzzer and a separate power supply is needed to charge this battery. I guess it is not possible to power the buzzer using telephone line.

You can also modify this project as suggested by Colin Mitchell.

Door Ajar Alert

In the 'Door Ajar Alert' circuit published in June 2011, the current can be reduced considerably by choosing the value of R1 as 1-mega-ohm. Also remove R3 and replace D2 with a 10-kilo-ohm resistor.

Colin Mitchell

From electronicsforu.com

The author T.K. Hareendran replies:

This is a simple 3V battery-operated circuit with moderate current drain in active state. The suggestions from Colin Mitchell may improve the overall performance but I am not in a position to re-test my prototype with the said modifications. Further, I request Mitchell to explain practical advantages of these modifications and how these reduce the current.

ERRATA

In the interview of Mr Yatish Mohan (managing director, Rohde & Schwarz India) published in EFY January 2013 issue, his name has been spelt incorrectly as Yatesh Mohan. The error is regretted.